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Resolution 240210 Compliance Report City and County of San Francisco — Ethnic & Community Media Advertising

Prepared by:

Assoc. Professor Jesse Garnier
Department of Journalism
San Francisco State University

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(Supervisors Dorsey; Preston)
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Live Dashboard: datadiver.jlabsf.org/city-budget?tab=advertising

FINAL FISCAL YEAR 2025-26 EDITION — FOR COALITION REVIEW — NOT FOR PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION

This edition updates the March 2026 draft with complete fiscal-year 2025-26 data, following the close of the city’s fiscal year on June 30, 2026. The data-backed findings in this report are derived from the city’s public financial records and reflect what is visible in that data. However, several assertions — particularly regarding agency pass-through spending, P-card purchases, and department-level advertising practices — require verification by the departments themselves before this report is finalized for public release.

I invite coalition input on:

- The denominator question (Section 4) — which interpretation of “discretionary advertising” should the coalition advocate for?
- The media classification registry — are there outlets missing or miscategorized?
- The recommendations — which are highest priority for the coalition’s advocacy
- The overall framing and tone — does this report serve the coalition’s goals?

Following coalition review, a revised version will be prepared for presentation to city departments, with an opportunity for departments to respond to the findings before public release.

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Executive Summary

San Francisco is failing to meet the advertising equity target established by its Board of Supervisors.

Resolution 240210 urges city departments to spend at least **50% of discretionary advertising budgets** with locally owned ethnic and community journalism outlets. Our analysis of 8.1 million vendor payment records finds:

<i>Metric</i>	<i>FY2025 (complete)</i>	<i>FY2026 (complete)</i>	<i>Target</i>
Compliance rate	5.8%	8.2%	50%
Ethnic media spend	\$60,547	\$70,489	—
Discretionary ad spend	\$1,037,241	\$863,441	—
Shortfall to 50%	(\$458,074)	(\$361,232)	—
Ethnic outlets paid	9	10	~98 available

The city needs to redirect approximately \$361,000 per year from its existing discretionary advertising budget to reach the 50% target — roughly 42 cents of every discretionary advertising dollar.

Selected departments lead the way. MTA consistently exceeds the 50% target (69.2% in FY2026), placing ads with 8 different ethnic and community outlets. The Assessor-Recorder, Economic & Workforce Development, and the Board of Supervisors also met the target on smaller budgets, and HSA — 98.7% in FY2025 — finished FY2026 just below it at 45.1%. These departments demonstrate compliance is operationally achievable — the question is how to extend their practices citywide.

The longer trend remains **down**, despite a first uptick. From a peak of 21.0% in FY2022, community and ethnic media’s share of discretionary advertising fell to single digits, reaching its floor of 5.8% in FY2025. FY2026 — the second complete fiscal year since the resolution’s adoption — recovered to 8.2%, the first year-over-year improvement since FY2022. It is still less than one-fifth of the target, and the resolution has not yet served to move the city meaningfully toward it.

Three Open Questions

1. **Why do most departments spend zero?** Of ~26 departments with advertising budgets, only a few direct any dollars at all toward ethnic media. MTA and HSA demonstrate compliance is achievable — what barriers prevent other departments from following their lead?
2. **Does any of the \$36.5 million in agency contracts reach community or ethnic media?** Agencies like Civic Edge Consulting (\$23.8 million through FY2026) and Most Likely To (\$4.9 million) receive city funds for marketing and communications work not classified as “Advertising” in the financial system. Some of this spending may well include ethnic media placements — but we cannot tell from the data. Departments and agencies are best positioned to answer this question.
3. **What are P-card advertising purchases being used for?** Between \$33,000 and \$59,000 per year classified as advertising is purchased via procurement cards (P-

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cards), appearing only as “P-CARD ONLY US BANK N.A.” These may be digital platform buys (Facebook, Google), but they could also include other media. Departments using P-cards for advertising can clarify what these purchases represent.

1. About Resolution 240210

On March 12, 2024, the San Francisco Board of Supervisors adopted Resolution 240210 (Resolution No. 117-24, “Recognizing and Supporting Ethnic and Community Journalism”), sponsored by Supervisors Matt Dorsey and Dean Preston, by a 10-0 vote. The resolution became effective March 22, 2024, without the Mayor’s signature. The resolution, in part:

RESOLVED, That the Board of Supervisors urges City departments to sustain their spending of at least half of their annual discretionary advertising budgets with locally owned and run ethnic and community journalism outlets, which includes nonprofit and for-profit media organizations.

FURTHER RESOLVED, That the Board of Supervisors urges the City to publicly report how much money is spent on ethnic and community journalism publications each year.

FURTHER RESOLVED, That the Board of Supervisors recognizes local news as a public good.

The resolution was girded by a **2023 Budget and Legislative Analyst (BLA) report** that found:

- Just **7 of 98** San Francisco community and ethnic media outlets identified under the report receive city advertising dollars
- Many departments purchase ads through **third-party agencies**, and those expenditures are **not categorized as advertising** in the city’s financial system
- Increasing ethnic media ad spend requires **streamlining** the city’s procurement processes

The BLA report also found that FY2022–2023 ethnic media spending “exceeds fifty percent of total **print and digital** discretionary advertising.” As Section 4 of this report explains, that finding used a narrower denominator than our analysis. When all discretionary advertising is considered — including out-of-home, radio/TV, and agency-placed media — the ethnic media share is significantly lower.

2. Methodology

What We Measure

The percentage of the city’s discretionary advertising spend that reaches ethnic and community journalism outlets, computed as:

Compliance % = Ethnic Media Spend / Total Discretionary Advertising × 100

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The Denominator: Discretionary Advertising

Included: All vendor payments where the city's financial system classifies the expenditure under sub_object = 'Advertising' (Socrata dataset n9pm-xkyq).

Excluded from the denominator:

<i>Vendor</i>	<i>Spend through FY2026</i>	<i>Reason for Exclusion</i>
Daily Journal Corporation	\$7.93M	Mandatory legal publications — public hearing notices, bid advertisements, and ordinance publications required by law
California Newspaper Service Bureau	\$2.08M	Mandatory legal notice distribution — not discretionary outreach

These vendors are excluded because legal notice publication is **mandated by statute**, not a discretionary advertising choice. Including them would inflate the denominator and misrepresent the spending departments actually control.

The Numerator: Ethnic & Community Media Spends

Vendors are classified using an open-source registry maintained in DataDiver's codebase (src/utis/mediaClassification.ts). The registry currently identifies **more than two dozen ethnic and community media outlets** organized by community:

<i>Community</i>	<i>Outlets in Registry</i>
Chinese-language	Sing Tao Daily, Wind Newspaper, World Journal, Chinese Times
Spanish-language	El Mensajero, El Tecolote/Accion Latina, El Reportero
Filipino	Philippine News, Fil-Am Radio
Korean/Asian/South Asian	Korea Times, India Currents, Center for Asian American Media
LGBTQ+	Bay Area Reporter, San Francisco Bay Times
African American	San Francisco Bay View
Neighborhood / Hyperlocal	SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association, Mission Local, Broke-Ass Stuart, The Potrero View, Hoodline
Multicultural Radio	Multicultural Radio Broadcasting

This registry is auditable. It is published as open-source code, not a proprietary database. Any classification can be inspected, challenged, or corrected. The live dashboard links each vendor to its classification rationale.

What We Do NOT Count

1. **Agency pass-through spending** — When a department pays an agency like Civic Edge Consulting or Most Likely To, the agency may place ads in ethnic media. But the city's payment records show only the agency, not the ultimate outlet. We cannot credit spending we cannot verify.

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2. **P-card advertising** — Procurement card purchases appear as “P-CARD ONLY US BANK N.A.” with no outlet identification. These are possibly direct-to-platform digital buys (Facebook, Google, Instagram), but we cannot confirm this.
3. **Non-advertising payments** — Some media outlets receive city payments for services other than advertising (e.g., translation, event hosting, subscriptions). Only payments classified as sub_object = ‘Advertising’ are counted.

Alignment with the BLA Methodology

Our methodology aligns with the 2023 BLA report’s approach of using the city’s financial classification system as the baseline. One important difference: the BLA reported compliance against “print and digital” discretionary advertising specifically, while our analysis uses **all** discretionary advertising (including out-of-home, radio/TV, and other media types). This broader denominator produces a lower compliance percentage but more accurately reflects the total advertising budget departments control.

Independent Validation: The 2022 OEWD File

In August 2022, the city’s Office of Economic and Workforce Development (OEWD) prepared a detailed file of advertising voucher payments covering 2017 through mid-2022 in response to a community request. This file — pulled from the same underlying financial system DataDiver queries today — classified 116 city vendors as either “Community and Ethnic Print Media” (10 vendors) or “Other Media” (106 vendors), and attached a broader list of 31 SF community and ethnic media outlets the city tracks as part of the local information ecosystem.

Applying DataDiver’s classification methodology to OEWD’s raw voucher data, we match the city’s own classification to 100% across all 10 vendors OEWD labeled as Community and Ethnic Print Media — \$518,912.01 in aggregate, exact to the penny. DataDiver additionally catches two vendors OEWD omitted (Multicultural Radio Broadcasting, \$54,135; Center for Asian American Media, \$7,500), both of which are legitimate community and ethnic media by any reasonable definition.

The three-layer model (tagged, agency, p-card) is validated by OEWD’s own data ordering. In the 2017–2022 period, the top four advertising recipients were Daily Journal Corporation (\$1.73 million, legal notices), Zeba Consulting (\$1.19 million, full-service agency), Promotion Marketing (\$340k, agency), and Intersection Media (\$312K out-of-home) — exactly the categories DataDiver’s three-layer model was designed to surface as non-community spending. OEWD labeled all four as “Other Media,” confirming they should not count toward compliance.

A more striking finding from the same file: OEWD’s broader 31-outlet ecosystem list names 19 community and ethnic media outlets that received **zero dollars** in city advertising payments across the full 5+ year period covered by the file. Full validation tables and the complete zero-payment outlet list are in Appendix D. The OEWD source file and our cross-reference CSV are version-controlled at reports/validation/ alongside this report.

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Fiscal Year Convention

San Francisco's fiscal year runs July 1 through June 30. "FY2026" = July 1, 2025 – June 30, 2026. This edition covers the complete fiscal year, as reflected in the July 17, 2026 weekly data load (see Known Limitations on the city's year-end close).

3. Findings: Historical Compliance Trend

Citywide Compliance Rate, FY2018–FY2026

<i>Fiscal Year</i>	<i>Total Advertising</i>	<i>Legal Notices</i>	<i>Discretionary</i>	<i>Ethnic Media</i>	<i>Compliance %</i>	<i>Outlets Paid</i>
FY2018	\$1,137,376	\$409,540	\$727,836	\$130,755	18.0%	8
FY2019	\$1,227,364	\$512,790	\$714,574	\$126,980	17.8%	9
FY2020	\$1,611,905	\$409,304	\$1,202,601	\$151,420	12.6%	10
FY2021	\$1,674,180	\$317,459	\$1,356,721	\$159,262	11.7%	7
FY2022	\$1,491,282	\$455,411	\$1,035,871	\$217,942	21.0%	9
FY2023	\$1,559,847	\$290,395	\$1,269,452	\$163,094	12.8%	10
FY2024	\$1,538,522	\$318,377	\$1,220,145	\$90,993	7.5%	11
FY2025	\$1,408,531	\$371,290	\$1,037,241	\$60,547	5.8%	9
FY2026	\$1,368,053	\$504,612	\$863,441	\$70,489	8.2%	10

FY2019 and FY2020 figures are revised slightly upward from the March 2026 draft: the classification registry gained two OEWD-validated community outlets (The Potrero View; Hoodline/Pixel Labs) during the independent-validation work documented in Appendix D. No other historical year changed.

Key Observations

The trend turned upward in FY2026 — modestly. After peaking at 21.0% in FY2022, ethnic media's share retreated steadily to its floor of 5.8% in FY2025, the lowest rate in the nine-year measurement window. FY2026's 8.2% is the first year-over-year improvement since FY2022. It is also still the third-lowest rate on record.

Ethnic media spending remains far below its peak in absolute terms. The \$70,489 spent in FY2026 is a 16% increase over FY2025 — and a 68% decline from FY2022's \$217,942. The recovery is real, but small.

Legal notices, not discretionary outreach, drove FY2026's advertising total.

Mandatory legal publications hit a record \$504,612 in FY2026 — 37% of all tagged advertising, up from \$371,290 in FY 2025 — led by Board of Supervisors (\$218,948) and City Planning (\$128,982) notice publications through Daily Journal Corporation. Discretionary spending, the budget departments actually control, shrank 17% to \$863,441. The rising compliance percentage partly reflects a shrinking denominator.

The number of outlets receiving payments has plateaued. Despite the BLA identifying 98 media outlets in San Francisco, fewer than a dozen ethnic/community outlets have received city advertising dollars in any given year. This number has barely changed since FY2018.

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The 50% target has never been met under this methodology. The highest recorded compliance would have been 21.0% in FY2022 — less than half the target — had the resolution been in place at the time.

4. The Denominator Question — A Critical Choice for the Coalition

The BLA’s 2023 report found that ethnic media spending in FY2022–2023 “exceeds fifty percent of total **print and digital** discretionary advertising.” Resolution 240210 cites this finding.

Our analysis of the same data finds different numbers — not because of a data error, but because the compliance percentage changes dramatically depending on what you include in the denominator. **The definition of “discretionary advertising” is a significant consequential decision within this analysis.**

Two Lenses, Two Realities

We computed compliance under two definitions of the denominator — the resolution’s plain language and the BLA’s narrower framing:

Resolution Standard — All Discretionary Advertising (this report’s primary method): Total sub_object = ‘Advertising’ minus legal notices. Includes newspapers, radio/TV, billboards, agencies, digital, P-card, recruitment ads, and everything else classified as advertising.

BLA Standard — Print and Digital Only: Ethnic press + metro dailies (Chronicle, Examiner) + P-card (likely digital) + unclassified vendors. Excludes out-of-home (billboards, transit), radio/TV broadcast, agencies, recruitment advertising, and production. This aligns with the BLA’s language of “print and digital discretionary advertising.”

<i>Fiscal Year</i>	<i>Resolution Standard (All Discretionary)</i>	<i>BLA Standard (Print + Digital only)</i>
FY2018	18.0%	33.2%
FY2019	17.8%	41.4%
FY2020	12.6%	34.3%
FY2021	11.7%	46.2%
FY2022	21.0%	40.8%
FY2023	12.8%	33.3%
FY2024	7.5%	22.9%
FY2025	5.8%	18.2%
FY2026	8.2%	18.5%

The denominator may also be affected by how agency contracts are classified. When a department tags an entire full-service agency contract as “Advertising” — including strategy, creative, and project management fees — the denominator grows beyond actual media placements. This is a distinct problem from Section 6’s untagged agencies: here the issue is not missing data, but potentially overstated data.

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What Each Standard Reveals

Under the Resolution Standard (all discretionary), the city has never come close to the 50% target. The peak would have been 21.0% in FY2022, and actual compliance under the resolution has yet to rise above single digits — 5.8% in FY2025 and 8.2% in FY2026. This is the most comprehensive standard and reflects the plain language of the resolution (“discretionary advertising budgets”).

Under the BLA Standard (print + digital), the city would have come closest in FY2021 at 46.2% and hovered in the 33–41% range for several years — approaching but not reaching 50%. However, this measure has also declined sharply since FY2022, running at 18.2% in FY2025 and 18.5% in FY2026 under the resolution. Even under the more favorable BLA methodology, the city remains well below the target.

Neither standard shows current compliance. The BLA’s 2023 finding that spending “exceeds fifty percent” likely used an even narrower definition or included department survey data beyond what appears in the financial system. Regardless, both standards agree on the scale of the gap: the city’s compliance runs at less than two-fifths of the target under the BLA standard, and less than one-fifth under the resolution’s.

Why the Denominator Matters So Much

The gap between the two standards exists because most city advertising spending is *not* print or digital media. In FY2026, the advertising budget includes:

<i>Category</i>	<i>FY2026 Spend</i>	<i>Resolution Standard?</i>	<i>BLA Standard?</i>
Ethnic & community press	\$70,489	Yes	Yes
Metro dailies (Chronicle, Examiner)	\$4,171	Yes	Yes
P-card (likely digital)	\$35,751	Yes	Yes
Other / unclassified	\$270,067	Yes	Yes
Radio & TV (KRON, KTSF, etc.)	\$46,729	Yes	No
Out-of-home (Clear Channel, etc.)	\$23,894	Yes	No
Agencies (Most Likely To, Great Kolor, etc.)	\$412,339	Yes	No
Denominator total		\$863,441	\$380,478
FY2026 Compliance %		8.2%	18.5%

The same \$70,489 in ethnic media spending produces a compliance rate of either 8.2% or 18.5% depending on the denominator. The numerator doesn’t change — only the question of what it’s measured against.

Under both standards, the city is well short of the 50% target. But the choice of standard affects how large the gap appears, what categories of spending become subject to the target, and what kinds of changes are needed to close the gap.

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A Question for the Coalition

Which standard should the coalition advocate for?

- **The Resolution Standard (all discretionary)** is the broader position. It says: every dollar a department spends on advertising — including billboards, TV, agency campaigns, and digital — should be subject to the 50% target. This demands the most change and captures the full scope of city advertising.
- **The BLA Standard (print + digital)** is narrower. It says: the 50% target applies to print and digital media placements, but not to billboards, broadcast, or agency overhead. This aligns with the BLA’s language and produces a smaller gap, but the city is still well below 50%.

Under either standard, the city is out of compliance. The coalition’s position on this question will shape the size of the ask and the advocacy strategy. This report currently uses the Resolution Standard as the primary measure, with the BLA Standard presented alongside it.

Recommendation

Regardless of which standard the coalition adopts, we recommend the Board of Supervisors **clarify the resolution’s intent** by specifying whether “discretionary advertising budgets” means:

1. All discretionary advertising (Resolution Standard), or
2. Print and digital media placements specifically (BLA Standard)

Without this clarification, the city and the coalition will continue measuring against different standards — and both will believe their numbers are correct.

5. Department Report Card

FY2026 (Most Recent Complete Year)

<i>Status</i>	<i>Department</i>	<i>Ethnic Media</i>	<i>Discretionary Total</i>	<i>Compliance %</i>	<i>Outlets</i>
✓	MTA Municipal Transportation Agency	\$41,171	\$59,461	69.2%	8
✓	ASR Assessor-Recorder	\$2,000	\$2,000	100.0%	1
✓	ECN Economic & Workforce Development	\$702	\$702	100.0%	1
✓	BOS Board of Supervisors	\$385	\$385	100.0%	1
⚠	HSA Human Services Agency	\$18,531	\$41,122	45.1%	3
✗	LIB Public Library	\$4,770	\$138,431	3.4%	2
✗	HRD Human Resources	\$2,930	\$62,932	4.7%	3
✗	REG Elections	\$0	\$240,357	0.0%	0
✗	SHF Sheriff	\$0	\$121,118	0.0%	0

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Status	Department	Ethnic Media	Discretionary Total	Compliance %	Outlets
X	PUC Public Utilities Commission	\$0	\$110,265	0.0%	0
X	DPH Public Health	\$0	\$28,743	0.0%	0
X	DAT District Attorney	\$0	\$25,000	0.0%	0
X	PRT Port	\$0	\$11,773	0.0%	0

Seven additional departments recorded small zero-ethnic discretionary amounts under \$5,000 in FY2026 (Recreation & Park, City Planning, Airport, Rent Board, Child Support Services, Building Inspection, Treasurer–Tax Collector). Police, a \$10,000 discretionary spender in FY2025, recorded no discretionary advertising in FY2026. Departments with no discretionary advertising spend are excluded — the resolution does not apply to departments without advertising budgets. See “Departments with No Discretionary Advertising Budget” below.

FY2025 (Prior Year)

Status	Department	Ethnic Media	Discretionary Total	Compliance %	Outlets
✓	HSA Human Services Agency	\$13,358	\$13,539	98.7%	2
✓	ASR Assessor-Recorder	\$4,854	\$4,854	100.0%	1
✓	MTA Municipal Transportation Agency	\$30,231	\$52,839	57.2%	6
✓	BOS Board of Supervisors	\$480	\$480	100.0%	1
X	HRD Human Resources	\$6,668	\$163,662	4.1%	3
X	LIB Public Library	\$3,011	\$67,075	4.5%	2
X	PUC Public Utilities Commission	\$1,945	\$46,452	4.2%	2
X	REG Elections	\$0	\$444,325	0.0%	0
X	DPH Public Health	\$0	\$88,790	0.0%	0
X	CSS Child Support Services	\$0	\$37,500	0.0%	0
X	SHF Sheriff	\$0	\$27,093	0.0%	0
X	PRT Port	\$0	\$25,124	0.0%	0
X	DAT District Attorney	\$0	\$18,860	0.0%	0
X	ECN Economic & Workforce Development	\$0	\$13,500	0.0%	0
X	POL Police	\$0	\$10,000	0.0%	0
X	HRC Human Rights Commission	\$0	\$9,500	0.0%	0

Compliance Leaders

MTA is the model department — and proof that compliance works. The Municipal Transportation Agency spends 57–69% of its discretionary advertising with ethnic media,

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placing ads across 6–8 different community outlets including Sing Tao, World Journal, Bay Area Reporter, El Reportero, SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association, and others. In FY2026 it reached 69.2% — its strongest year in the measurement window — across 8 outlets. MTA demonstrates that meeting the 50% target is operationally achievable at scale — this is a department with a \$53K–\$59K annual advertising budget, not a token effort. Other departments looking for a template should look at MTA’s media buying practices.

HSA leads in commitment. Human Services Agency directed 98.7% of its FY2025 advertising to ethnic media — nearly every discretionary dollar. Its FY2026 figure of 45.1% finished just under the target on a larger budget (\$41,122), showing that small-budget departments can swing year to year on a few buy cycles — but HSA’s consistent prioritization of community outlets is notable.

ASR, ECN, and BOS demonstrate that even small budgets can comply. The Assessor-Recorder, Economic & Workforce Development, and the Board of Supervisors each directed 100% of their (modest) advertising to ethnic media in FY2026. These are small dollar amounts (\$385–\$2,000), but they show that compliance isn’t a function of budget size — it’s a function of choice.

Departments with No Discretionary Advertising Budget

The following departments show **no discretionary advertising spend** in the measured period and are therefore not applicable for compliance measurement. These departments are not non-compliant — they simply don’t have advertising budgets that the resolution applies to:

- Mayor’s Office (MYR)
- Controller (CON)
- Public Works (DPW)
- Fire Department (FIR)
- GSA - City Administrator (ADM) — minimal/zero in most years

These departments are excluded from compliance scoring. If they begin purchasing advertising in future fiscal years, they would be included at that time.

The Recruitment Advertising Gap

Several of the departments with zero or near-zero ethnic media compliance are primarily spending on **recruitment advertising** — job announcements for positions in law enforcement, public safety, and city government. This deserves special attention because recruitment advertising that bypasses ethnic and community media directly affects **who learns about job opportunities in city government** and, by extension, the diversity of the city’s workforce.

Sheriff (\$121,118 discretionary in FY2026, 0% ethnic media): The Sheriff’s advertising includes Professional Sports Publications (\$24,500), KRON TV (\$20,000), Cole Pro Media (\$18,750), “Top of the World Media” (\$13,000), Flipbird Films (\$10,000), Rivet Campus Media (\$4,275), SACJOBS.COM (\$2,142), and \$28,451 across 11 payments recorded only as “Single Payment Payees” — the financial system’s aggregation for one-time payees, which obscures the recipients entirely. These appear to be recruitment placements. Not a single

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dollar went to Chinese-language, Spanish-language, Filipino, African American, or LGBTQ+ press — the communities that make up the majority of San Francisco’s population.

Human Resources (\$62,932 discretionary in FY2026, 4.7% ethnic media): HRD spends heavily through agencies — Great Kolor LLC (\$39,996) — and on law enforcement trade press (PORAC Law Enforcement News, \$11,750). HRD does place some ethnic media: World Journal (\$1,380), Sing Tao Daily (\$960), and Wind Newspaper (\$590). But the ratio is stark: \$11,750 in a single law enforcement trade publication versus \$2,930 total across all ethnic press.

Police (\$10,000 in FY2025, 0% ethnic media): SFPD’s FY2025 advertising went to a music production company and legal notices. No community media placements. The department recorded no discretionary advertising at all in FY2026.

District Attorney (\$25,000 in FY2026, 0% ethnic media): Spent entirely through Better World Advertising, an agency. Whether any of that agency spend reached ethnic media is unknown (see Section 6).

If the city wants a workforce that reflects its communities, the departments doing the hiring need to advertise where those communities read, watch, and listen. A recruitment ad in PORAC Law Enforcement News reaches people who already work in law enforcement. A recruitment ad in El Reportero, Sing Tao, or the Bay Area Reporter reaches people who might never otherwise learn the Sheriff’s department is hiring. **This is arguably the most consequential category of advertising the resolution covers.**

Other Opportunities for Improvement

Elections represents the largest single opportunity — and the clearest example of the agency opacity problem. The Department of Elections spent \$459,732 on advertising in FY2025 and \$260,412 in FY2026 — the largest departmental ad budget over the two years combined. Nearly all of it went to a single agency, Most Likely To Inc: \$424,980 in FY2025 (92% of that year’s total) and \$240,357 in FY2026 (100% of the year’s discretionary spend), with the remainder going to legal notices (Daily Journal: \$15,408 and \$20,055) and small miscellaneous payments. No ethnic media placements are recorded in either year. It is possible that Most Likely To placed some of Elections’ ads in ethnic media on the department’s behalf, but the payment data shows only the agency, not the ultimate outlets. Given Elections’ mission of broad democratic participation, this department could have an outsized impact on citywide compliance — and on reaching voters in underserved communities — if it incorporated ethnic and community outlets into its media mix, either directly or by requiring its agency to report outlet-level placements. There is also a recordkeeping question: the city’s financial system classifies Most Likely To’s entire contract as “Advertising,” though it likely includes non-placement services such as strategy, creative development, and project management. If the advertising classification overstates the actual media placement amount, the compliance denominator is inflated by non-advertising costs. The Department of Elections can clarify: of the \$665,337 paid to Most Likely To across FY2025 and FY2026, how much was spent on media placements, and with which outlets?

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The agency-routing pattern spread to the Public Library in FY2026. The Library’s discretionary ad spend more than doubled to \$138,431, and \$106,986 of it — 77% — went to Most Likely To under the same tagged-as-Advertising arrangement as Elections. The Library continued small direct community placements (Broke-Ass Stuart, \$3,600; Wind Newspaper, \$1,170), but its measured compliance fell from 4.5% to 3.4% while most of its budget moved into an opaque channel.

Public Health shows \$0 in identifiable ethnic media advertising, but \$28,593 in FY2026 P-card advertising (see Section 7) and substantial agency contracts. Some of this spending may reach ethnic or community audiences through channels not visible in the payment data. DPH’s input on what these purchases represent would help complete the picture.

HRD and LIB remain marginally engaged; PUC disengaged in FY2026. Human Resources (4.7%) and the Public Library (3.4%) each directed a small share of advertising to ethnic media and have existing relationships with community outlets — the foundation is there for scaling those placements toward the 50% target. The Public Utilities Commission, at 4.2% in FY2025, recorded no ethnic media placements at all in FY2026 against \$110,265 in discretionary spend — the largest reversal among previously engaged departments.

6. Agency Spending: What We Can See, and What We Can’t

The 2023 BLA report identified a structural issue: many departments purchase advertising through third-party agencies, and those purchases are **not classified as advertising** in the city’s financial system.

Our analysis confirms that substantial spending flows through marketing and communications agencies under non-advertising budget codes. The following agencies receive city payments typically classified as “Professional & Specialized Services” or “Other Current Expenses” (totals through FY2026):

<i>Agency</i>	<i>Total Non-Ad Spend</i>	<i>Primary Departments</i>	<i>Transactions</i>
Civic Edge Consulting (all entities)	\$23,757,391	Airport, MTA, DPH, Port, PUC, ECN	1,514
O’Rorke Inc	\$5,169,495	Environment, Wastewater, DPH, Port, Elections	752
Most Likely To Inc	\$4,906,194	Environment, PUC, HSA	174
Better World Advertising	\$1,587,270	DPH, District Attorney	49
ZEBA Consulting Inc	\$720,684	Emergency Management	7
Great Kolor LLC	\$168,726	Human Resources, Police	18
Promotion Marketing	\$137,263	Human Resources, MTA	105
CKR Interactive	\$99,209	Technology, Human Resources	48

Total agency spending not classified as advertising: \$36.5 million (all fiscal years through FY2026). This edition itemizes O’Rorke Inc and CKR Interactive, which were included in the March draft’s total but not listed individually.

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What We Don't Know — And Who Can Tell Us

These agencies provide marketing, communications, and outreach services that likely include some media placement — buying ads in newspapers, on radio, on digital platforms, and on billboards. But because the contracts are classified under broad service categories, the specific media placements are not visible in the city's financial data.

This is the largest gap in our compliance picture. It is possible that significant ethnic media spending is happening through these agencies and simply not being captured. If even 10% of agency-managed spending included ethnic media placements, it could meaningfully change the compliance numbers.

A related issue affects agencies whose contracts are tagged as Advertising — most notably Most Likely To's work for the Department of Elections (\$424,980 in FY2025 and \$240,357 in FY2026) and, new in FY2026, the Public Library (\$106,986). Unlike the agencies listed above, this spending is classified as Advertising and counts in the compliance denominator. But the same opacity applies: we cannot see whether the agency placed ads in ethnic media, in mainstream media, or spent the funds on non-placement services. The classification as "Advertising" may overstate the actual media buy, inflating the denominator with strategy and creative costs that are not discretionary ad placements. This affects the accuracy of both the numerator and the denominator.

We invite departments and their agency partners to share media placement data.

Questions for Departments and Agencies

1. **What media outlets receive placements through these agency contracts?** A breakdown by outlet name and amount would allow us to credit ethnic media buys that currently go uncounted.
2. **Do agency contracts include ethnic media placement requirements?** If so, are they being met?
3. **Can report-back requirements be added to existing contracts?** The BLA recommended this; the resolution endorses it. Implementation would close the largest data gap in compliance measurement.

7. P-Card Advertising: An Open Question

Procurement cards (P-cards) allow city employees to make small purchases without a formal purchase order. When used for advertising, the vendor appears as "**P-CARD ONLY US BANK N.A.**" and does not reveal the media outlet that may have received the payment.

P-Card Advertising Trend

<i>Fiscal Year</i>	<i>P-Card Ad Spend</i>	<i>Primary Department</i>
FY2018	\$4,932	DPH (\$3,188)
FY2019	\$20,888	DPH (\$12,889)
FY2020	\$13,594	DPH (\$5,939)
FY2021	\$46,082	PUC (\$28,966)
FY2022	\$38,665	DPH (\$33,144)
FY2023	\$58,615	DPH (\$55,105)

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<i>Fiscal Year</i>	<i>P-Card Ad Spend</i>	<i>Primary Department</i>
FY2024	\$45,746	DPH (\$36,954)
FY2025	\$47,111	DPH (\$37,719)
FY2026	\$35,751	DPH (\$28,593)

What Are These Purchases?

The payment method offers a clue — traditional media (newspapers, radio, TV, billboards) typically invoice through accounts payable, while digital platforms (Meta, etc.) accept credit card payment for small, immediate ad buys. This suggests P-card advertising may skew toward digital platforms, but **we cannot confirm this without department input.**

The Department of Public Health is the primary P-card advertiser, spending \$28,593 in FY2026. This is consistent with health campaigns using social media boosts for targeted outreach — but DPH is best positioned to confirm what these purchases represent.

Questions for Departments

1. **What platforms or outlets are receiving P-card advertising payments?** Even a summary breakdown (e.g., “80% Facebook/Instagram, 20% Google”) would significantly improve the compliance picture.
2. **Could any of these purchases reach ethnic or community audiences?** Some digital platforms offer geo-targeted and language-targeted advertising that may serve the same communities as ethnic media outlets.
3. **Would standard purchase orders be feasible for these buys?** Shifting from P-card to PO-based purchasing would create a vendor record, improving transparency without necessarily increasing procurement burden.

The Compliance Implication

P-card advertising totaling \$33,000–\$59,000 per year is included in the discretionary advertising denominator but **cannot be counted toward ethnic media compliance** because the outlet is unknown. Greater transparency around these purchases could either reveal an additional compliance gap or — if some P-card spend does reach ethnic-adjacent audiences — improve the measured compliance rate.

8. Who Receives City Advertising Dollars

Ethnic & Community Media Outlets Paid in FY2026

<i>Outlet</i>	<i>FY2026</i>	<i>Transactions</i>	<i>Community Served</i>
SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association	\$22,919	8	Citywide neighborhood press
Bay Area Reporter	\$15,379	14	LGBTQ+
World Journal SF	\$9,178	10	Chinese-language
Wind Newspaper	\$6,370	5	Chinese-language
Sing Tao Newspapers SF	\$6,048	7	Chinese-language
Broke-Ass Stuart	\$3,600	6	Hyperlocal/culture
Sing Tao Daily	\$2,845	3	Chinese-language

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<i>Outlet</i>	<i>FY2026</i>	<i>Transactions</i>	<i>Community Served</i>
El Reportero	\$2,600	2	Spanish-language
San Francisco Bay Times	\$1,000	1	LGBTQ+
Mission Local SF	\$550	1	Mission District / hyperlocal

Total: \$70,489 across 10 outlets.

Communities Not Yet Reached

The following community types have **no identified city advertising spend** in FY2026. This may reflect vendor registration barriers, a lack of awareness within departments, or gaps in our classification registry:

- **African American press** (e.g., San Francisco Bay View)
- **Filipino press** (e.g., Philippine News)
- **Korean press** (e.g., Korea Times)
- **South Asian press** (e.g., India Currents)

Onboarding these outlets as city vendors (see Recommendation 4) and including them in the outlet directory (Recommendation 5) would expand the pool of options available to departments and help the city reach communities currently underserved by its advertising.

Top Non-Ethnic Advertising Vendors (FY2026)

<i>Vendor</i>	<i>FY2026 Spend</i>	<i>Category</i>
Daily Journal Corporation	\$504,052	Legal notices (excluded from compliance)
Most Likely To Inc	\$347,343	Full-service agency (Elections, Library)
China Basin Ballpark Company (Giants)	\$70,000	Sports venue advertising (PUC)
Great Kolor LLC	\$39,996	Full-service agency
P-CARD ONLY US BANK N.A. (DPH)	\$28,593	Untraceable digital
Single Payment Payees (Sheriff)	\$28,451	Aggregated one-time payees
Better World Advertising	\$25,000	Digital agency
Professional Sports Publications	\$24,500	Sports media
Clear Channel Outdoor	\$23,894	Out-of-home
AD CLUB	\$20,313	Industry association
KRON	\$20,000	Television
Cole Pro Media Corp	\$18,750	Media production
ComputerLand of Silicon Valley	\$16,775	Technology
KTSF TV26	\$15,990	Chinese-language television

KTSF TV26 (\$15,990) is a notable case — it is a Chinese-language television station that serves the same communities as classified ethnic press outlets. Under a broader interpretation of “ethnic and community journalism,” KTSF might qualify. Our current

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registry classifies it under “Radio & TV” rather than “Community & Ethnic Press” because the resolution specifically references journalism outlets, not broadcast stations. This classification is reviewable.

9. Recommendations

Improve Measurement: Close the Data Gaps

1. Clarify the 50% target denominator. The Board should specify whether “discretionary advertising budgets” means all advertising or only print and digital. The compliance measurement depends entirely on this definition.

2. Require agency media placement reporting. All city contracts with advertising or marketing agencies should require itemized reporting of which media outlets receive placements, as the BLA recommended. This would illuminate the \$36.5 million currently invisible in agency pass-through. Departments and agencies are invited to share existing placement data voluntarily in the interim.

3. Improve P-card advertising transparency. Departments that use P-cards for advertising should document which platforms or outlets receive those payments. Where feasible, shifting to standard purchase orders would create a vendor record without adding significant procurement burden.

Increase Supply: Onboard Ethnic & Community Media as City Vendors

4. Aggressively onboard ethnic and community outlets into the city vendor system. A significant barrier to compliance is that many ethnic media outlets are not registered city vendors. Departments cannot easily place ads with outlets that are not in the procurement system. Rather than asking each outlet to navigate the city’s vendor registration process independently, the city could seek to adopt a civic media marketplace platform — a centralized system where community publishers maintain verified profiles with audience demographics, ad rates, platform reach, and languages served, and where city departments can discover, match, and procure media placements through a streamlined workflow. Such a platform could function as the outlet directory the BLA recommended, the vendor onboarding pipeline the procurement system lacks, and the compliance reporting tool the resolution calls for — in a single system. The city should work with SFIMC (SF Independent Media Coalition) and other press associations to seed the platform with publisher profiles.

5. Create the BLA-recommended outlet directory. The BLA recommended a directory of ethnic and community journalism outlets. A static directory is a start, but what departments actually need is a discovery and matching tool — one that lets a communications officer describe a campaign’s target audience (e.g., “Cantonese-speaking seniors in the Sunset” or “Spanish-speaking families in the Mission”) and receive ranked recommendations of community publishers who reach those audiences, with estimated costs, reach, and engagement metrics. This goes beyond a phone list: it should incorporate census-derived demographic overlays, publisher-reported audience data, and geographic coverage maps so that departments can make informed media buying decisions without specialized knowledge of the ethnic media landscape.

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6. Appoint the liaison position. The BLA recommended a staff member to serve as liaison between departments and community outlets. This position would address the operational friction that prevents departments from placing ethnic media ads — connecting publishers who want city business with departments that need to reach diverse communities.

Build Capacity: Expand What Counts as Ethnic Media Advertising

7. Help ethnic media outlets build digital and display advertising capacity. The resolution’s language — “ethnic and community journalism outlets” — is not limited to print placements. Many ethnic media outlets operate websites, social media channels, email newsletters, and mobile apps that accept display advertising, sponsored content, and social promotion. The city should:

- **Inventory the digital ad capacity** of registered ethnic media outlets (e.g., does El Tecolote accept web display ads? Does Sing Tao offer sponsored social posts?)
- **Include digital placements** in the definition of ethnic media advertising, so that a Facebook-targeted campaign run *through* an ethnic media outlet’s social channels counts toward compliance
- **Fund capacity building** to help outlets that currently lack programmatic ad infrastructure develop it — a one-time investment that creates a permanent new channel for city advertising

A civic media marketplace platform could accelerate this by allowing publishers to connect their social media accounts, display their engagement metrics, and offer digital placements (sponsored posts, newsletter ads, web display) alongside traditional print ads — all in one rate card. This makes the publisher’s full inventory visible to city buyers and removes the friction of negotiating custom digital deals outlet by outlet.

8. Redirect social media ad spend through ethnic media channels. Departments currently spending on direct-to-platform digital ads (via P-cards or agencies) should explore whether those same campaigns can be placed through ethnic media outlets’ digital properties. A civic media marketplace platform would make this operationally simple: a department could select target communities, see which publishers serve those audiences across which platforms (Instagram, Facebook, newsletter, web display), place orders at published rates, and receive delivery confirmation with engagement metrics — all with a procurement-ready audit trail. A DPH health campaign that currently buys Facebook boosts via P-card could instead be routed through community outlets’ social channels, reaching the same audiences while supporting local journalism and generating a transparent, auditable compliance record.

9. Establish a citywide advertising gateway with community and ethnic media provisions. A civic media marketplace platform could serve as the operational backbone of such a gateway — providing the publisher inventory, rate standardization, order management, delivery tracking, and compliance reporting that citywide contracts requires. Rather than building this infrastructure from scratch within city procurement, the city could partner with an existing platform purpose-built for connecting government advertisers with community media.

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Prioritize Recruitment Advertising

10. Require ethnic media inclusion in all recruitment advertising. Recruitment advertising is where the resolution’s goals intersect most directly with the city’s equity commitments. When the Sheriff’s department places \$24,500 in Professional Sports Publications and \$20,000 on KRON but \$0 in any ethnic or community press, it is recruiting from some communities and not others. Departments with public safety and civil service recruitment budgets — Sheriff, Human Resources, Police, District Attorney — should be required to include ethnic and community media placements in every recruitment campaign. This is not just a media equity issue; it is a workforce diversity issue. The communities that read Sing Tao, El Reportero, the Bay Area Reporter, and the San Francisco Bay View deserve to know their city is hiring. A discovery platform with demographic and community matching would make this straightforward: a department posting a recruitment campaign could instantly see which publishers reach Chinese-speaking, Spanish-speaking, Filipino, African American, and LGBTQ+ communities, compare rates, and place orders — eliminating the “we didn’t know who to call” barrier that likely explains much of the current gap.

Sustain Progress: Reporting and Accountability

11. Issue department-level compliance targets. Departments with significant expenditures — Elections (\$240,357 in FY2026, entirely through a single agency), the Public Library (\$138,431, mostly agency-routed), Sheriff (\$121,118, primarily recruitment), and the Public Utilities Commission (\$110,265, zero ethnic placements) — each represent significant opportunities to improve the citywide number. Department-specific improvement plans, with interim milestones, would create accountability without requiring new legislation. For departments whose spending flows primarily through agencies, compliance targets should include requirements that agencies report outlet-level placements and incorporate ethnic media into their media plans.

12. Fund annual compliance reporting. This analysis demonstrates that compliance monitoring is technically feasible using existing open data. The city should fund regular (at minimum annual) compliance reporting, with DataDiver or a similar tool providing the public-facing dashboard the resolution calls for. A civic media marketplace platform with built-in order tracking and compliance tagging could generate this reporting automatically — every placement routed through the platform would be tagged by department, fiscal year, publisher, community served, and amount, creating the audit trail that the current financial system lacks. This would make compliance reporting a byproduct of the buying process rather than a separate analytical exercise.

10. Data Sources & Attribution

All data in this report is derived from publicly available San Francisco open data, queried via the Socrata Open Data API (SODA).

<i>Dataset</i>	<i>Socrata ID</i>	<i>Records</i>	<i>Coverage</i>	<i>Update Frequency</i>
Vendor Payments (Vouchers)	n9pm-xkyq	8.1M	FY2007–present	Weekly
Supplier Contracts	cqi5-hm2d	47K	FY2018–present	Weekly

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Figures in this edition reflect the dataset's July 17, 2026 weekly load — the first complete post-fiscal-year-end snapshot.

Reproducibility

Every figure in this report can be independently verified:

1. **Live dashboard:** The DataDiver compliance monitoring tool at datadiver.jlabsf.org/city-budget?tab=advertising shows real-time compliance metrics with drill-down to individual payment records.
2. **CSV export:** Every aggregated view in DataDiver includes a “Based on N records” link that exports the exact source records as CSV.
3. **Open-source methodology:** The media classification registry is published as open-source code at `src/utis/mediaClassification.ts`. The compliance computation is at `src/hooks/useComplianceData.ts`. Both are inspectable and auditable.
4. **URL-encoded state:** Any finding can be bookmarked and shared via URL. Filter parameters (fiscal year, department, media category) are encoded in the URL for citation purposes.
5. **Direct API access:** The underlying Socrata dataset is publicly queryable. For example, to retrieve all FY2026 advertising payments:

```
https://data.sfgov.org/resource/n9pm-xkyq.json?
$select=vendor, department, SUM(vouchers_paid) as total_paid
&$where=sub_object = 'Advertising' AND fiscal_year = '2026'
&$group=vendor, department
&$order=total_paid DESC
```

Known Limitations

1. **Agency pass-through:** We cannot see which media outlets receive placements through agency contracts. This likely undercounts ethnic media spending. Department and agency input would improve accuracy (see Section 6).
2. **P-card opacity:** The \$33,000–\$59,000/year in P-card advertising cannot be attributed to any media outlet. Department input on what these purchases represent would close this gap (see Section 7).
3. **Registry completeness:** Our registry covers known recipients from payment data. There may be ethnic media outlets receiving city dollars under names not yet in the registry.
4. **Year-end close:** FY2026 figures reflect the July 17, 2026 weekly data load, taken after the June 30 fiscal year end. No FY2026 advertising vouchers were pending payment at that pull, but the Controller's year-end close can post late or corrected FY2026 vouchers into the fall. Figures may shift modestly; the live dashboard always reflects the current data.

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5. **Classification judgments:** Categorizing vendors as “ethnic and community press” involves editorial judgment. Our classifications are transparent, auditable, and open to challenge. The case of KTSF TV26 (Chinese-language television) illustrates the boundary questions.
6. **Resolution is non-binding:** Resolution 240210 is a statement of policy intent, not an ordinance. Departments are urged but not legally required to comply.

Appendix A: Ethnic Media Classification Registry

The following vendors are classified as “Community & Ethnic Press” in DataDiver’s media classification system. This registry is maintained as open-source code and is subject to ongoing review.

Chinese-Language Press

- Sing Tao Daily / Sing Tao Newspapers San Francisco Ltd
- World Journal SF LLC
- Chinese Times
- Wind Newspaper

Spanish-Language Press

- El Mensajero
- El Reportero LLC
- El Tecolote/Accion Latina

Filipino Press

- Philippine News
- Fil-Am Radio

Korean / South Asian Press

- Korea Times
- India Currents
- Center for Asian American Media

LGBTQ+ Press

- Bay Area Reporter
- San Francisco Bay Times

African American Press

- San Francisco Bay View

Neighborhood / Hyperlocal

- SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association
- Mission Local SF
- Broke-Ass Stuart
- The Potrero View
- Hoodline / Pixel Labs Inc

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Multicultural Radio

- Multicultural Radio Broadcasting

Appendix B: Legal Notice Exclusions

The following vendors are excluded from the discretionary advertising denominator because their payments represent **mandatory legal publications** required by statute, not discretionary outreach:

<i>Vendor</i>	<i>FY2025 Spend</i>	<i>FY2026 Spend</i>	<i>Total through FY2026</i>
Daily Journal Corporation	\$369,881	\$504,052	\$7.93M
California Newspaper Service Bureau	\$1,409	\$560	\$2.08M

These vendors publish public hearing notices, bid advertisements, and ordinance publications as required by California Government Code. Their exclusion from the discretionary denominator is consistent with the BLA's approach and is transparent: the live dashboard shows the excluded amounts in a hatched segment of the advertising composition bar. FY2026's record legal-notice total — driven by Board of Supervisors and City Planning notice publications — is discussed in Section 3.

Appendix C: Glossary

<i>Term</i>	<i>Definition</i>
Discretionary advertising	City advertising spending where the department chooses the media outlet. Excludes mandatory legal notice publications.
Ethnic and community journalism	Locally owned or run outlets where one-third of readership are San Franciscans, employing at least one full-time staff member within 30 miles of SF (per Resolution 240210 definition).
P-card	Procurement card (city-issued credit card) used for small purchases. Vendor appears as the issuing bank, not the ultimate recipient.
Tagged advertising	Vendor payments classified under sub_object = 'Advertising' in the city's financial system.
Agency layer	Payments to known advertising/marketing agencies under non-advertising budget classifications.
Fiscal year (FY)	San Francisco's fiscal year runs July 1 – June 30. FY2026 = July 2025 – June 2026.
BLA	San Francisco Budget and Legislative Analyst, the independent fiscal advisor to the Board of Supervisors.
SODA API	Socrata Open Data API, the interface for querying SF Open Data programmatically.
Compliance rate	Ethnic media spend ÷ total discretionary advertising × 100. Target: ≥50% per Resolution 240210.

Appendix D: Independent Validation Against the 2022 OEWD File

Source document: reports/validation/8.30.22_Advertising_Voucher_Payments_2017-2021_OEWD_File.xlsx — prepared by the SF Office of Economic and Workforce Development on August 30, 2022 for community partner review. Contains 3,806

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advertising voucher lines from 2017 through mid-2022 (pulled May 18, 2022), organized across four sheets: raw voucher data, year-by-year pivot tables, a by-vendor sort view, and a manual vendor classification.

Why it matters. This file predates DataDiver’s existence by four years and was prepared by the city itself. Its classification of vendors into “Community and Ethnic Print Media” versus “Other Media” provides an independent check on DataDiver’s classification methodology. The file’s underlying voucher data is equivalent to DataDiver’s primary source — both pull Account Description = ‘Advertising’ (equivalent to Socrata’s sub_object = ‘Advertising’) from the same city financial system.

D.1 Classification Match: 100% on OEWD’s 10-Vendor List

OEWD’s classification marked exactly 10 suppliers as Community and Ethnic Print Media. DataDiver’s classifier (after the minor Potrero View / Pixel Labs / Hoodline pattern additions documented in this report’s commit history) matches all ten:

<i>OEWD-classified C&E Vendor</i>	<i>2017–2022 Spend</i>	<i>DataDiver Match</i>
SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association	\$264,819	✓
Bay Area Reporter	\$108,766	✓
World Journal	\$54,558	✓
Sing Tao Daily	\$36,431	✓
Sing Tao Newspapers SF Ltd	\$28,304	✓
San Francisco Bay Times	\$21,000	✓
The Potrero View Inc	\$2,805	✓
San Francisco Bay View Inc	\$1,130	✓
El Reportero / The Reporter	\$600	✓
Pixel Labs Inc dba Hoodline.com	\$500	✓
TOTAL	\$518,912.01	100.00%

Match rate: 100.00% — exact to the penny. DataDiver’s classification recovers OEWD’s own categorization without exception.

D.2 Classifier Additions Beyond OEWD’s Narrow List

DataDiver classifies two additional vendors as community and ethnic press that OEWD’s narrow print-focused list did not:

<i>Vendor</i>	<i>2017– 2022 Spend</i>	<i>Category</i>	<i>Rationale</i>
Multicultural Radio Broadcasting	\$54,135	Multilingual radio	Serves multilingual Bay Area audiences; legitimate community media infrastructure outside OEWD’s “print” scope
Center for Asian American Media	\$7,500	Asian American	Major SF-based Asian American media organization

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Both additions are defensible on editorial grounds. OEWD’s list was explicitly titled “Community and Ethnic **Print** Media” – DataDiver’s broader scope includes multilingual radio and Asian American media institutions that serve the same communities through different channels.

D.3 Three-Layer Model Validation

Applying DataDiver’s full classifier to OEWD’s 2017–2022 voucher data produces the following category breakdown:

<i>Category</i>	<i>Vendors</i>	<i>Total 2017–2022</i>	<i>Share</i>
Legal notices (Daily Journal Corp)	1	\$1,727,840	27.9%
Full-service agencies (Zeba, Promotion, Great Kolor)	3	\$1,704,310	27.5%
Unknown / unclassified	76	\$667,851	10.8%
Community and ethnic press	12	\$580,547	9.4%
Radio & TV	7	\$429,938	6.9%
Out-of-home (Intersection, CBS Outdoor, etc.)	3	\$385,107	6.2%
Major metro print (SF Chronicle, SF Media Co)	2	\$259,847	4.2%
Digital agency (CKR Interactive)	1	\$169,122	2.7%
Direct social (LinkedIn)	1	\$136,204	2.2%
P-card	9	\$89,585	1.4%
Production	2	\$43,788	0.7%
TOTAL	117	\$6,194,140	100.0%

Key findings from the breakdown:

- **Legal notices alone capture 27.9% of all tagged advertising** – confirming the decision to exclude Daily Journal Corporation from the discretionary denominator. This is not a policy choice the city advertising program has; it is statutory compliance spending.
- **Full-service agencies capture 27.5%** – confirming the three-layer model’s “agency layer.” One vendor alone (Zeba Consulting, \$1.19M) received more than twice the entire community and ethnic press total over the same period.
- **Community and ethnic press received 9.4%** of all tagged advertising over 2017–2022 – directionally consistent with DataDiver’s current measurement on live FY-based data.
- **The “unknown” bucket** at 10.8% is a remaining classification frontier, though spot-checks of the top unknowns show they are primarily recruitment agencies, historical publisher entities, and individual radio call-letter groupings – not miscategorized community media.

D.4 The Broader 31-Outlet Ecosystem: A Zero-Payment Finding

OEWD maintained a second list in the same workbook – the “SF Ethnic & Community News Media Outlets” column – naming 31 outlets (after deduplication) the city recognized as part of the SF community and ethnic media ecosystem. Cross-referencing this broader

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list against the raw voucher data reveals that 19 of 31 outlets (61%) received zero dollars in city advertising payments over the 5+ year period covered by the file.

Outlets receiving ZERO city advertising payments, 2017–2022:

<i>Outlet</i>	<i>Community Served</i>
Mission Local	Neighborhood (nonprofit)
El Tecolote / Accion Latina	Spanish / Latino
SF Public Press	Investigative (nonprofit)
48 Hills	Progressive (digital)
Nichi Bei Weekly	Japanese
Wind Newspaper	Chinese (bilingual)
The Ingleside Light	Neighborhood
Sunset Beacon	Neighborhood
Richmond Review	Neighborhood
Marina Times	Neighborhood
Noe Valley Times	Neighborhood
Broke-Ass Stuart	Alternative weekly
J. The Jewish News	Jewish
Catholic San Francisco	Religious
Street Sheet	Homeless services
El Mensajero	Spanish / Latino
Telemundo KSTS-TV48	Spanish / Latino
Public Comment SF	Civic
Westside Observer	Neighborhood

The 12 outlets that did receive payments captured \$595,492 in aggregate over the period — but distribution was highly concentrated. Just four vendors (SF Neighborhood Newspaper Association \$264,819; Bay Area Reporter \$108,766; Sing Tao Daily \$64,734; World Journal \$54,558) received 82% of that total.

Reading this finding in context: The city itself, as of August 2022, named 31 community and ethnic media outlets as part of the SF ecosystem. Its own payment records showed that 19 of them had been paid nothing for advertising across five years. This is the empirical baseline Resolution 240210 was enacted to change. Two complete fiscal years after the resolution’s adoption, most of those outlets still receive nothing. A few have since appeared in the payment records — Wind Newspaper (from FY2022), Mission Local and Accion Latina, El Tecolote’s publisher (FY2025), Broke-Ass Stuart (FY2026) — but the FY2026 recipient list still numbers just 10 outlets.

The machine-readable cross-reference is preserved at reports/validation/oewd-broader-outlet-crossref-2017-2022.csv for future re-analysis.

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D.5 Reconciliation Limits

This validation does not prove that DataDiver’s current FY2025–FY2026 numbers are correct — it proves that DataDiver’s **classification methodology** agrees with the city’s own classification when applied to the same underlying data. Two specific reconciliation limits to note:

- **Calendar year vs. fiscal year.** OEWD’s pivot tables are organized by calendar year (2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022). This report and the DataDiver dashboard use SF fiscal years (July 1 – June 30). A calendar year 2020 total cannot be directly compared to a fiscal year 2020 total; the overlap is only 50%. Directional comparisons are valid; exact year-by-year matching is not.
- **Data lag.** The OEWD file was pulled May 18, 2022, meaning its “2022” column captures only about five months of calendar year 2022 (the \$500 total in that column reflects this partial-year cutoff). Any comparison using the 2022 column should treat it as a partial-year snapshot.

The source file is preserved at reports/validation/ for future re-analysis as methodology questions arise.

This report was generated using data from the City and County of San Francisco’s open data portal (data.sfgov.org). All figures are derived from the Vendor Payments dataset (n9pm-xkyq) and are independently verifiable. The DataDiver civic data platform is developed by Assoc. Professor Jesse Garnier, San Francisco State University.

Live compliance monitoring: datadiver.jlabsf.org/city-budget?tab=advertising